TA studio brief — Independent surface and structure challenge

Pathway: TRACK · Week 3 Part 2 · Big question: How can we combine collagraph relief, foil embossing, and monochromatic wash in an architectural panel?

TA practical setup & focus

Have damp tissues and dry kitchen roll ready on every table so pupils can wipe high foil points straight after brushing wash.

Studio kit: A4 heavy greyboard panels, corrugated card, craft foil, foam pads, blunt styluses, black/sepia acrylic wash, white/chrome dry-brush pigment

Key words to prompt

• collagraph: A textured relief board built by gluing varied flat and bumpy materials onto a base.

• monochromatic: Using dark, mid, and light tones of a single colour plus black and white.

• recessed: Set further back into the surface so it catches deeper shadow.

• patina: The weathered surface look that metal or stone develops over time.

• flange: The projecting rim or edge of a structural steel beam.

Supported route steps

1. Glue one corrugated background strip and two smooth girder bars onto your greyboard base.

2. Emboss a row of rivets on a foil strip, glue it across the centre joint, and press the edges firm.

3. Brush dark wash over the foil and seams, then dab the top of the foil clean with a paper towel.

4. Skim chrome dry-brush across the ridged card.

Check: Three-texture architectural tile completed with dark groove wash and bright ridges.

Review & exit support

Exit question: What happens when you brush dark wash over embossed foil and gently wipe the raised top surface?

Staff note: Staff preparation only: review a short demonstration of collagraph assembly and ink-and-wipe patina on embossed foil.